Module III
INDIVIDUAL AND SOCIETY

Preface

The third module, Individual and Society, includes an introduction to the basic sociological concepts that explain human behaviour and social life. This module is designed to take you through the intricacies of the individual's relationship with the social world and, in doing so, equip you with the analytical tools necessary to understand the social realities that one encounters every day.

The module begins with the study of social interaction, which is the main interaction between people. You will examine different forms of interaction such as cooperation, competition, conflict, and exchange, and see how communication processes define the organization of life at the family level. Supported by this understanding, the module proceeds with the analysis of social groups, where you will discover the differences between primary and secondary groups; you will also understand how they help in the formation of identity and behavior patterns, both within and outside groups.

In addition, the module pays great attention to socialization. This is a lifelong process by which individuals acquire norms, values, and social roles. We will look at socialization and its different types; the main agents include the family, schools, peer groups, the media, and the developmental stages of an individual as a member of society.

The final part of the module is about social control and the ways it maintains order, conformity, and predictability in social life. You will examine formal and informal social controls that support social norms and values, as well as different groups such as the legal system, religious institutions, and public opinion.

Upon completion of this module, you will have a comprehensive knowledge of basic sociological concepts and a high level of understanding of how social forces affect personal choices, beliefs, and interactions. Such knowledge will better enable you to engage critically with social issues and thereby make a valuable contribution to civic life, whatever your field of study.

3.1- A- Social Interaction

Learning objectives

- Define the term social interactions
- Identify different types of social interactions, including cooperation, competition, conflict, social exchange, and accommodation.
- Differentiate between social interaction types in various real world contexts.
- Analyze the role of social interactions in building relationships and maintaining social order

Learning Outcomes

- Describe the term social interaction
- Explain different types of social interaction with examples of everyday life situations
- Discuss the role of social interactions in forming group dynamics and maintaining social order
- Describe fundamental differences between various types of social interaction such as Accommodations versus Assimilations, Cooperation versus Conflict, Competitions versus Conflict and Cooperation versus Competitions.

Introduction

Humans exist as social beings that develop through cultural influences, while social life serves as a basic necessity for their survival. It is difficult for humans to live alone or exist completely isolated from society. Humans have organized themselves into various groups throughout their lives. Members of all groups exhibit specific behaviours and patterns of behaviour. People show certain behaviours because they observe the behaviours and actions of others around them. Behavioural systems develop through the process of communication. Interaction is necessary for social and group life to exist because it requires contact between people. People who are physically close to each other do not automatically form a social unit or group. Social relationships require interaction to establish them as their basic structural element. So in simple terms, we

Interaction

Interactions can be viewed as encounters between at least two people in which they attend to one another and adjust their behavior in response to one another.

So simply we can say that interaction is a mutual or reciprocal action or influence between two or more entities. These entities can be people, objects, technologies or even species

can say that interaction is the basic building block of social relationships.

Social interaction is necessary for a person to build his social life from the very beginning. The system creates social relationships, which may establish themselves as permanent elements of the system. People accept traditional systems and stereotyped ways of life as the only way to find order in life. It is also true that life is dynamic, fast-moving and changing. People move through life as they pursue their goals while competing, working together and finding balance before new conflicts arise. Social interaction acts as the active factor that creates the functional elements of social systems. Therefore, social interaction is the basis of society. It is a core part of social life. Accordingly, this term is central to any analysis of the dynamics of society and culture.

Definitions

- Green:- social interaction as 'the mutual influences that individuals and groups have on one another in their attempts to solve problems and in their striving towards goals'.
- Dawson and Gettys:- 'Social interaction is the process whereby men interpenetrate the minds of each other'.
- Gist, NP:- 'Social interaction is the reciprocal influence human beings exert on each other through inter stimulation and response'.
- Eldredge and Merril:- 'Social interaction is the general process whereby two or more persons are in meaningful contact as a result of which their behaviour is modified, however slightly'.

According to these definitions, we can say that social contact and communication act as essential requirements that make social interaction possible.

Elements of social interactions

According to Park and Burgess the two essential elements for social interaction;- communication and contact.

1. Contact: The initial phase of communication is contact. Two distinct social units or people establish contact through the process of meeting, which defines contact. People develop their own responses to others' actions through this process which produces both external actions and internal changes. The two forms of contact exist; (i) Contact in time (ii) Contact in space

(i) Contact in time:- Contact in time refers to contact of a group with the earlier generations through customs, traditions, folkways, morals, etc.

(ii) Contact in space:- it refers to the relationship between contemporary individuals and groups within a particular area. The contacts may be primary and personal or secondary and impersonal in nature.

2. Communication: Interaction occurs through communication. People can understand the ideas and feelings of others through the behaviours observed during communication. This process involves three distinct stages; these combine sensory perception with emotional responses and cognitive understanding. "At the sensory level, seeing, hearing, smelling, and touching all play a role in evoking responses. At the emotional level, facial expressions, blushing, and laughter all evoke responses. Communication at the third level, which takes place through the intellect, is limited to humans". Language plays an important role in this context. Humans use language to convey abstract thoughts to other living beings. This facilitates the transmission of cultural heritage.

The importance of social interaction

Sociologists view everyday interactions between individuals as the basic building blocks that form the core structure of social organization. Although people take these everyday events for granted, they are the core structure of social organization. People use interaction to describe actively changing relationships with one another. Social roles (positions) and rules (norms) act as fixed elements of society, but interaction acts as its dynamic, moving element. Interactions exist in a variety of ways because interactions can demonstrate selflessness and purposeful behaviour and can occur in both formal and informal settings. All types of interactions serve as essential building blocks because they establish the foundation that supports group survival and social organization.

Social interaction serves as the foundation that supports our entire social existence. The collective process stands out as the most inclusive approach of all the available options. It is an environment in which personality develops. Human contact serves as an essential element of identifying as an individual. The survival of society depends on the presence of many people who engage in social contact. Humans establish social relationships through shared rules that include social norms, legal systems, and behavioural expectations. Social contact is the fundamental process by which social structure and human behaviour evolve and change.

Conclusion

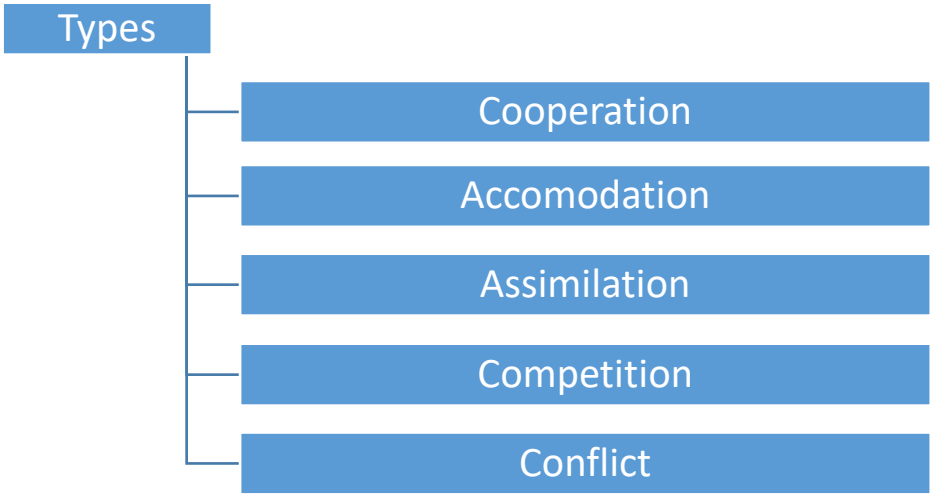
When two people meet for the first time, they usually greet each other or at least establish some kind of connection. In everyday social life, greetings like “good morning,” “how are you?” or “hello” have more meaning than they realize. These greetings obey clear social rules, set mutual expectations for how people should behave toward each other, and contribute to the maintenance of stable patterns of relationships. Over time, these repeated interactions reinforce existing patterns of relationships and, in turn, lay the foundation for society itself.

Social interaction is the most basic unit of analysis. However, whether or not they interact-and how meaningful or effective that interaction is- depends on a number of factors: the size and structure of the group, the types of relationships between the individuals involved, and the broader social context in which the interaction takes place.

3.1-B - Types of Social interaction

Introduction

Humans have built hundreds of social relationships, which can reach thousands when they exist in society. Humans do not have the ability to fully examine all social relationships that exist in all their forms. For proper analysis, social relationships require classification into basic categories. Social relationships need to be organized into categories because they involve different types of interactions. The types of social interactions that people use to communicate with each other fall under the category of social processes. It includes;



3.1-B- (i) Cooperation

A type of social interaction known as cooperation occurs when people or groups work together to accomplish shared objectives or interests. Cooperation serves two purposes: workload division and work coordination.

The English word "co-operation" comes from the Latin words "co," which means together, and "operating," which means to work. In general, cooperation is the pursuit of similar or shared interests through coordinated efforts.

Cooperation is the most prevalent and enduring social process. Cooperation is viewed as an integrating behaviour and the antithesis of competition.

Definition

- W Green:- co-operation as 'the continuous and common endeavour of two or more persons to perform a task or to reach a goal that is commonly cherished'.
- Merril and Eldredge:- 'Cooperation is a form of social interaction wherein two or more persons work together to gain a common end'.
- Fairchild:- 'Cooperation is the process by which individuals or groups combine their effort, in a more or less organised way for the attainment of common objective'.

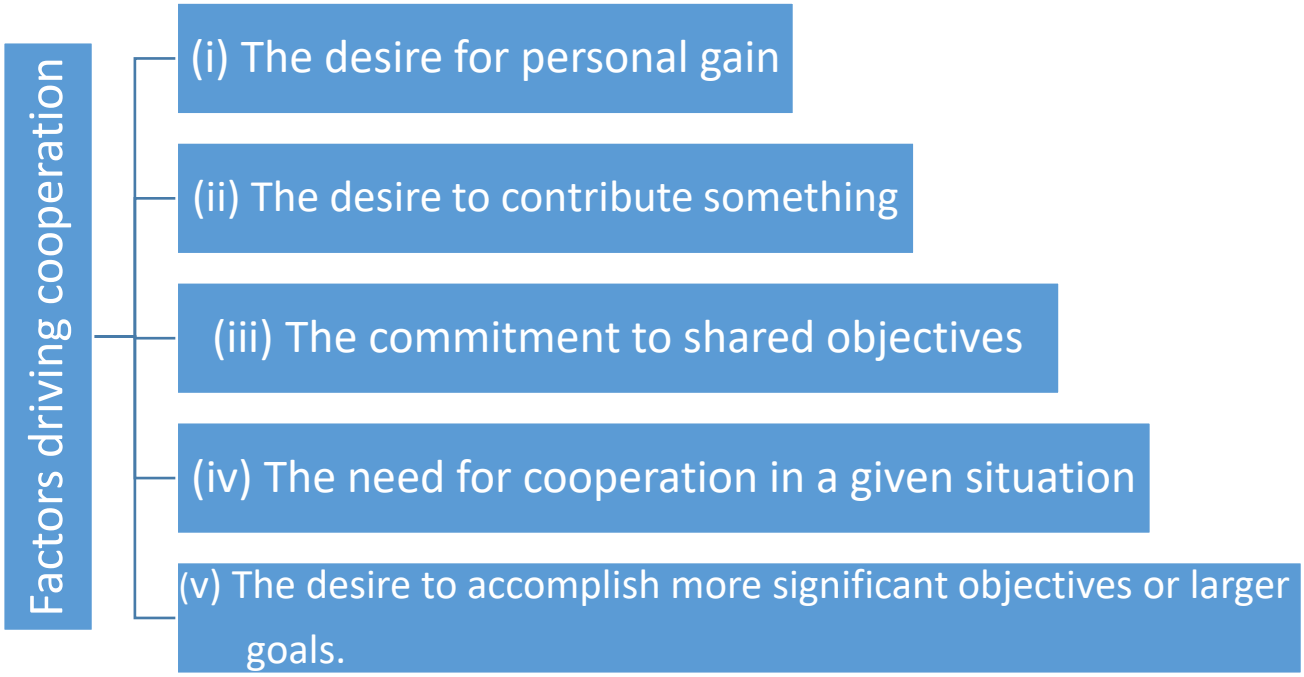
Thus, it is a cooperative action for the purposes of reaching common goals or gains. People participate in social interactions when they actively work toward achieving specific goals. The process consists of two main components:-

1- Common end

2- Organized effort

The co-worker operates under specific rules that exist to promote cooperative behaviour. The process of working together with others limits what individuals can achieve. People are required to give up some personal desires when choosing to work together with others. Established rules enforce a moral framework that does not exist in free-for-all situations.

Cooperation is defined as "joint action to achieve shared rewards or common goals." The process of cooperation requires two individuals to work together when they want to achieve a shared goal. This concept requires that others understand their needs and goals when expressing themselves.



People cooperate because they want to protect their own interests, to protect themselves, and to help others. Groups can cooperate to benefit all members, to defend themselves against each other, or to focus on their own progress, as a monopoly would do.

To work together effectively, people need to feel a connection with others. The process of cooperation becomes impossible when individuals fail to understand the feelings of others. The term cooperation exists under another name, mutual aid. Cooperation is possible only when there is a common mind-set, a common goal, mutual knowledge, understanding, helpfulness, and an unselfish attitude.

Types of cooperation

People use various social interaction methods to work together with others in their social environment. People use direct methods to cooperate with others while indirect methods occur through primary, secondary and tertiary forms of cooperation.

(I) Direct co-operation: Everyone involved in direct collaboration does the same work. Activities such as playing together, praying together, working to free a motor from mud, and working together to cultivate a field include the list. People work in partnership with others as a fundamental aspect of their professional activities. People experience social joy when they work together to achieve a common goal.

(II) Indirect Co-operation: This type of cooperation occurs when people perform different tasks toward a common goal, rather than working together on the same task. The concept of division

of labour and specialization serves as the foundation for this type of cooperation. Masons, plumbers, and carpenters working together to build a house demonstrate how they work toward a shared goal as each person completes the task assigned to them. In this case, people work independently to achieve their shared goal.

(III) Primary co-operation: The basis of cooperative behaviour is primary groups consisting of family members, friends, neighbours, and children's playmates. In this type of cooperation, both individual and organizational interests are found. Individual interests need to be realized in order for the interests of the group to be realized. Everyone works for the betterment of others. The process of recognizing individuals and groups and the tasks they complete occur simultaneously.

(IV) Secondary co-operation: Modern civilized society operates largely through secondary cooperation that exists within secondary group structures. Business organizations, churches, trade unions, and government agencies are examples of secondary groups that exhibit this type of cooperative behaviour. It is highly specialized and formalized. Group members develop loyalty to their team and its work because they gain personal benefits from their cooperative efforts. They can cooperate with others while maintaining their image. Various groups exhibit this type of behaviour, including political organizations, financial institutions, religious institutions, commercial enterprises, and educational institutions.

(V) Tertiary co-operation: Through this collaborative approach, various large and small organizations collaborate to address specific situations. Multiple religious groups, including castes, tribes, political parties, and other similar institutions, may experience this type of conflict. The two parties may unite to pursue the conflicting goals of different groups or may work together to remove a third party from the political scene. However, one party may want to dominate, while the other may want to gain sufficient public support. The two parties may join forces to achieve specific goals. Individuals participating in these partnerships may have opportunistic attitudes that lead to unstable and weak cooperative relationships.

Role of cooperation in social life

As a social process, cooperation is a universal phenomenon. We are surrounded by cooperation in every direction. Humans need cooperation for their survival because it fulfills psychological and biological needs that help keep humans alive. People learn their first cooperative behaviours through the experience of being part of a family unit. The achievement of most individual and group goals depends on this factor. People need this factor to survive through

all stages of life. When an individual does not cooperate with his members, his emotional and physical needs are not satisfied. Even his spiritual needs are not met.

According to C.H. Cooley, cooperation can only occur when men recognize that they have a common interest. They work together to achieve this goal together because they have enough time, intelligence, and self-control.

Young and Mack point out ‘Cooperation occurs under particular circumstances;

- All a motivation to seek a goal
- People ought to be partially aware of our advantages from cooperation. Since it is not a human instinct, cooperation requires a certain amount of training
- The people should be eager to share the work and the profits.
- They should equip themselves with the skills needed to execute the collective strategy.

Cooperation is a key factor in determining the rate of social evolution. The main reason why any professional progress of humanity is associated with the past is the collective spirit among people. When individuals come together, it means faster and better progress. The impact of human cooperation in science and technology, agriculture, industry, transportation, and communication is enormous. Great human cooperation in the fields of science and technology has led to man's first successful moon landing and the effort to reduce the gap between the standards of living in most developed and underdeveloped countries.

MacIver and Page point out that “without cooperation, without working together in pursuit of common or common interests, man cannot coexist.” Those who can do so can unleash a never-ending stream of enthusiasm. It strengthens relationships. Cooperation is not just a condition for people to live and work together in democracies. The growth of society indicates the increasing importance of cooperation.

Above all, cooperation is the greatest need of the day. It is needed not only between nations and individuals, but also between organizations, groups, and societies. It offers solutions to many problems and conflicts that exist in this world. Cooperation is especially necessary because life is characterized by interdependence. Social life becomes a mess, and without cooperation its movement is reversed.

3.1-B- (ii) Competition

Competition is a goal-oriented conflict in which competing parties or organizations pursue the same goals, but at the same time act in a socially acceptable manner. The central point of competition is to achieve goals through competition. The simplest form of social conflict is competition. It occurs spontaneously as part of the human struggle for existence. It is based on the assumption that no individual's desires can ever be fully satisfied. There is no competition for air or sunlight, as there is an unlimited supply. Competition occurs whenever the supply of things that people desire is low. In almost all areas, new achievements are often the result of competition. During fair competition, the competing parties do not intend to eliminate or injure the opponent.

Definition

- ☆ Bogardus:- ‘Competition is a contest to obtain something that does not exist in a quantity sufficient to meet the demand’.
- ☆ Anderson and Parker:- ‘Competition is that form of social action in which we strive against each other for the possession of or use of limited material or non-material good’.
- ☆ Park and Burgess:- "Competition is an interaction without social contact".
- ☆ Biexanz:- "Competition is the striving of two or more persons for the same goal which is limited so that all cannot share."
- ☆ Horton and Hunt:- "Competition is the struggle for possession of rewards which are limited in supply, goods, status, power, love-anything”

Nature and Characteristics of Competition

The features that decide the nature of competition are those mentioned below:

(i) Competition is impersonal struggle: According to Park and Burgess, competition is "interaction without social contact", and this is the main feature that characterizes competition. Usually, competition is not directed by a specific institution or person; the competitors do not communicate with each other, and they are not even aware of their competitors. In most cases, competition is impersonal. People who compete with other people, such as members of groups such as political parties, businesses, social or cultural groups, tribes, or nations, are called impersonal competitors.

(ii) Competition is a sub/unconscious process: Competition exists only in the most secret corners of people's minds. Competition exists as long as the focus is not on the opponent, but on the prize or goal to be achieved. Competition or personal rivalry disappears only when the competition is not aimed at teammates, but at opponents.

One can compete on an unconscious level. It is the most frequent case when those competing do not realize that they are in competition with each other. They are not usually aware of who their rivals are.

(iii) Scarcity conditions: Competition is where there are products and services that are in high demand. However, a core economic principle is that while human wants are unlimited, the resources to satisfy them are very limited. Therefore, people compete to acquire such limited resources.

(iv) Competition in wealth: Competition is likely to arise even in situations of wealth or affluence. There is competition not only for food, shelter, and other basic needs, but also for luxuries, power, name, fame, social position, and mates.

(v) Competition is endless: Competition is always going on. Almost everything in the social sphere that is based on action and interaction leads to it. Competition for fame, wealth, and status exists in almost all societies and is a continuum.

(vi) Competition is universal phenomena: Every age group and every civilization have competition. As the things people want are limited, there is a constant struggle to get them. The phenomenon of competition is one of the most important features of modern civilized society. Almost everything in our social life is now subject to competition. Politicians compete for power, lawyers for clients, doctors for patients, students for ranks or honours, athletes compete for trophies, young people compete for spouses, and businessmen for customers. However, no society is completely cooperative or competitive.

(vii) Competition is dynamic: It helps in achieving success and brings about social change. It raises the level of aspiration from a low level to a high level. Once a student has to compete for the college cricket team, later he may have to compete for the university cricket team, the state team and the national team.

(viii) Competition causes social change: Competition forces individuals to adopt new behaviours to achieve their goals. New behaviours include innovation and invention, which

can bring about social change. This is because an active society has more goals than a relatively static one; it is therefore an effect or by-product of social change.

(ix) Both impersonal and personal competition are possible: Competition is aimed at achieving a goal rather than harming an individual. Sometimes it happens without anyone knowing that the other person exists or has existed. In the civil service examination, it is impersonal when candidates do not even know each other's names. Personal competition can also arise when two individuals are competing for the same position. Thus competition is formed and eventually turns into conflict as the competition becomes more and more personal. Competition in society is completely impersonal. A person has no direct contact with other competitors, but is vaguely aware of them.

(x) Competition may either be a source of benefit or disadvantage to a person: It is a disadvantage when one of two or more competing individuals or organizations decides to do so at the expense of the other in the process of winning. Healthy competition is positive, and it is good for both competitors. It is also good for everyone's general health. Examples include farmers competing to grow the best crops, construction workers competing to maximize production, and college students competing to win awards.

(xi) Norms are always in control of competition; It is not free or unlimited. Unrestricted competition does not exist. This phrase is a term of contradiction. Competition is always monitored and regulated by moral standards or rules. Competitors are expected to use "fair tactics" instead of "killing tools."

Purpose of Competition

Three ultimate ends of competition are discussed in the book "The Theoretical Society" by G. R. Madan. These are;

(i) Competition is a way in which people find ways to satisfy a common need or desire when those organizations or individuals compete.

(ii) Competition directs attention to alternatives. Far-reaching technologies and inventions, behavioural changes, alternative philosophies, belief systems, etc., provide a wide range of choices that can meet the needs of society.

(iii) Competition helps in the selection of qualified members to perform specific group tasks. In the case of free competition in groups such as employment, religion, art, entertainment

reform, politics, and economics, the selection of qualified members to perform specific tasks becomes much simpler.

Forms or Types of Competition

Bernard mentions three broad types of competition as a set of social, economic and political competition.

1- Social competition: The desire for better positions and prestige has always existed among people. The societies in which this type of competition exists most intensely are the 'open' societies. Wherever individual talents, qualities, aptitudes and abilities are recognized, there is a fierce struggle for prestige. Democratic states are the most favourable for such competitions.

2- Economic competition: Economic competition is, on the one hand, the most important and, on the other hand, the most vicious type of competition. It can be seen in the methods of production, distribution and consumption of products. People fight for jobs, clients, patients, customers, profits, wages, promotions, salary increases, money, wealth and other things of value. Economic competition is visible at the individual and group levels.

3- Political Competition: In today's world, there is a constant struggle for political change and power. Political parties are constantly fighting for control of the government. Similarly, countries compete with each other on the global stage.

4- Cultural Competition: Cultural competition is also a phenomenon, It may involve two or more cultural groups. Examples of such competitions can be found throughout the history of mankind. Original culture and invaded culture have always been in competition with each other.

Role of Competition in Social Life

Competition is a major aspect that greatly influences our social life. Society is a great beneficiary of the power of competition to bring about radical changes in people's lives.

Social functions of competition

1- Gives people their respective status: The higher a person rises on the social ladder, the more he/she is involved in competition. Competition and social status are two sides of the same coin. While some compete to maintain their status, others try to climb the ladder

2- Motivational factor: One of the main sources of competition is the motivation of people to grow and develop themselves. It motivates the individual to do what he/she is best at. The individual's new output doubles.

3- Enables social mobility: From an individual perspective, competition is a way to gain more freedom and mobility. A person's competitive spirit can elevate his status.

4- Helps socio-economic progress: Fair competition between people or groups is a key factor in helping them advance economically and socially. Since it benefits individuals and companies to do their best, it benefits society as a whole. If competition is for the betterment of society, it can have great and wonderful results.

5- Provides the possibility of innovation: Competition enables people to satisfy their crave for innovation and promotion.

Competition is only creative if it is positive in nature. Some sociologists consider it a more fundamental process than cooperation. According to Hobbes, the main law of life is struggle, and the first humans were always fighting. The theory of survival of the fittest, an offspring of Darwin's theory of evolution, also emphasized the importance of competition in society. Social competition produces positive results.

According to H. T. Mazumdar, competition performs five positive functions.

1- It determines the social and individual role of members in a hierarchy system.

2- It tends to stimulate the economy, efficiency, and inventiveness.

3- It tends to increase one's pride.

4- It prevents the accumulation of the power in an individual or a group of persons.

5- It creates adherence to the established rules.

Apart from these viewpoints, Mazumdar has enumerated its negative aspects besides its positive functions.

1- It may lead to neurosis because of frustration

2- It may lead to monopoly

3- It may lead to conflicts

Here is a brief description of the functions that competition performs:

(i) Proper positioning of people: This places people on a social ladder. What people are allowed to do is decided through competition. Competition is the reason behind the division of labour and the entire complex economic machinery of modern existence. Competition is a major driving force of technological and organizational change.

(ii) Source of motivation: The need to lead, to be recognized, and to be rewarded is stimulated by competition. Through increased ambition, it raises the level of achievement; people put in more effort when competing with each other than when working individually without competition.

(iii) Fostering progress: Since fair competition forces individuals and businesses to give their best, it leads to the development of social, economic and general welfare. Because of its close relationship to what is called progress, some theorists consider it to be the foundation of modern civilization.

Competition can have a profound effect on individuals and corporations. It can cause emotional disturbances. It can cause individuals or institutions to become hostile and antagonistic towards each other. The most divisive effects arise from unfair competition. If not controlled, it becomes a struggle with immoral and violent behaviour. However, no society is completely cooperative or competitive. The social order is balanced between competitive and cooperative forces. However, competition should always be healthy and fair. If so, it can be a means of development for the group and the individual.

DIFFERENCES BETWEEN COOPERATION AND COMPETITION

Cooperation	Competition
Cooperation is a form of social relationship where two or more individuals cooperate to attain a common objective.	A form of social interaction that is called competition arises when individuals try to monopolize rewards by surpassing all their competitors.
The united or mutual efforts of the people are always the premise of cooperation.	Both the group level and individual level are feasible for competition.
Cooperation usually results in positive outcomes and does not cause significant losses to the parties involved.	While competition can be good, it can also cause loss or damage to the individuals and parties involved.

Cooperation has no boundaries. It has no limits. One can do anything to help others.	There are restrictions on competition. Norms restrict it. Unrestricted or unchecked competition may be harmful.
Cooperation requires qualities such as compassion, empathy, concern for others, interpersonal understanding, and a willingness to help others.	Qualities required for competition include strong ambitions, self-confidence, a desire to become famous in the world, an adventurous nature, and a willingness to face hardships and adversity.
Individuals are happier and more content when they cooperate.	Competition can cause anxiety, uncertainty, indefiniteness, and dissatisfaction.

3.1-B- (iii) Conflict

Conflict arises when participants prioritize personal relationships over common goals. Often the rules of competition are ignored and competitors are destroyed as a result of competition. Conflicts can arise when people or groups have different values, resources, and goals. As a result, in a conflict, one party gains at the expense of the other. However, conflicts are not always clear-cut or violent. For example, most conflicts are resolved through negotiation. The best example of nonviolent resistance is Gandhiji's Satyagraha to oppose British imperialism, which involved civil disobedience and nonviolence.

The process of conflict in human relationships is eternal. Conflict may be arise between individuals or groups. Conflict occurs whenever an individual or organization decides to gain an advantage by preventing competitors from competing successfully rather than by defeating them through competition. Furthermore, conflicts are not bad. They can be used for many beneficial purposes.

Definitions

- W. Green:- “Conflict as ‘the deliberate attempt to oppose, resist or coerce the will of another or others”.
- Gillin and Gillin:- “Conflict is the social process in which individuals or groups seek their ends by directly challenging the antagonist by violence or threat of violence”.
- Horton and Hunt:- “Conflict may be defined as a process of seeking to monopolise rewards by eliminating or weakening the competitors”.

- Young and Mack:- "Conflict takes the form of emotionalised and violent opposition, in which the major concern is to overcome the opponent as a means of securing a given goal or reward."

Nature and Characteristics of Conflict

1- Universal Nature: The clash or conflict between interests is a characteristic of conflicts, and it has a universal nature. Almost all societies have them. In some societies very strong and large conflicts exist, in others they are just trivial. All famous sociologists and historians, such as Saint-Simon, Karl Marx, Friedrich Engels, have recognized the crucial role of conflict in the life of human society. According to the founder of communism, Karl Marx, the history of mankind is the history of the struggle between classes. He argued that capitalists and workers are members of two social classes that differ in terms of their interests.

2. Conflicts are deliberate actions: Parties involved in conflicts (whether individuals or groups) recognize that they are in conflict with each other. Some sociologists point out that this is always a conscious thing and that this awareness leads to the adoption of the strongest emotions and passions.

3. Conflict is one of those situations where individuals become your enemies: when competition takes a personal turn, conflict arises. Unlike a competition where the opponent is defeated, here the achievement of the task is temporarily forgotten.

4. Conflicts are discontinuous and episodic: There have never been conflicts that never end. Sometimes they do. The very existence of societies is based on the fact that they cannot engage in wars that last forever.

5. Conflicts realize their importance since subjects upon which people have had vehement dissensions: Human history is largely about the different types of wars that society has witnessed. Wars between different social groups, religious communities, political parties, and countries have always been possible. The tendency of fighting or conflict depends on variables such as values, ideals, goals, religious beliefs, and attitudes, and those changes.

6. Conflict is a result of cultural conditioning: The culture of the group and its nature are the factors that determine conflict. Property, prestige, power, freedom of action, freedom of thought, or any other highly valued thing may be at stake. A political conflict will arise if the stability of a political order is threatened. If factionalism is strong, conflict would be expected in that area. The problems of any society are defined by the values that its culture provides.

7. Norms and Conflict: Culture not only shapes conflicts and their manifestations, it also regulates and controls them. More violent and unpredictable types of conflict are established where conflict is rare and appropriate strategies are not developed.

8. Personal or impersonal conflict: There are numerous types of conflicts. Conflicts could be between two individuals, families, races, classes, countries, or nations. At the same time Small or big groups could be practicing it.

9. Conflict solution measures: The major two conflict solution measures are (a) assimilation and (b) accommodation. The term "accommodation" is used to refer to how hostile individuals or groups come together. The opposing parties reach a temporary agreement. Between them, it is only a brief cessation of fighting, a temporary truce, or postponement. It can be carried out by different means, for example, coercion, compromise, mediation and reconciliation, tolerance, rationalization, sublimation, and transformation. Assimilation is "a process by which previously different individuals or groups become similar and identify with their common interests and outlook." It is a long-term conflict resolution.

10. Insecurity and frustration bring about conflict: When people are constantly thwarted in achieving their goals, they become truly frustrated. The need for wealth, money, status, prestige, power, or a combination of these may be one of these goals. Frustration can also be intensified by insecurities such as financial crisis, unemployment, and fear of losing love and affection. In such extreme cases, a person may even lose mental balance or commit suicide. Wherever insecurities exist, there is a possibility of conflict within society.

Causes of Conflict

Conflict has always been and will continue to be an inevitable part of human life. It is a very large phenomenon, existing in all places and at all times. There has never been a time or a culture where individuals or groups have not created conflict. In fact, the differences between human aspirations, expectations, grievances, and needs, and the rapidity with which a society's moral standards change, give rise to conflicts.

These factors are the cause of conflicts, in simple terms, namely,

(i) Differences between individuals: People are different in character, beliefs and attitudes. They cannot tolerate these differences and may even fight.

(ii) Cultural differences: The culture of a group is the life of that group. One group has one culture and another has another culture. Cultural differences between parties sometimes cause

conflict and tension. In the past, religious conflicts have led to persecution and violence. For example, religious conflicts were the main reason for the partition of India.

(iii) Conflict of interest: Different individuals or groups may sometimes have different interests. For example, conflicts arise when the interests of an employer and an employee differ.

(iv) Social change: Social change appears as a cause of conflict when one part of the society is unable to adapt to changes in another area. Conflict due to cultural lag caused by social change. Conflict between parents and children is caused by social change.

Types of Conflict

- George Simmel distinguished four categories of conflicts:

(i) War

War is a large-scale type of conflict that we know best. Before the rise of international trade, different groups of people could communicate only through fighting. In this case, conflict had a dissociative effect, although it was also a dissociative phenomenon. According to Simmel, man has an inherent hostility that results in war. However, this opposing impulse is only motivated to action if there is some goal - a possible one - the desire to achieve economic interest. The hostile impulse can be considered the basis of conflict.

(ii) Feud or factional conflict

Feud is a very destructive form of intra-group conflict that can escalate to a violent fight when one group accuses another of abusing them.

(iii) Litigation

When an individual or group claims to be entitled to certain rights based on objective factors, and then goes to court to resolve a disagreement, this is litigation, a form of legal conflict. In short, litigation is a legal battle undertaken by an individual or group to protect their property rights. Such a type of conflict is objective in nature.

(iv) Conflict of impersonal ideals.

A conflict of impersonal ideals is a type of conflict in which individuals fight for a cause, not for themselves. In such a conflict, each side seeks to prove the validity of its beliefs; for example, communists and capitalists struggle to prove that their system provides a more just global order.

- Gillin and Gillin have identified five kinds of conflicts:

(i) Personal conflict

An interpersonal conflict is any type of disagreement that occurs between two members of the same institution, for example, between two students.

(ii) Racial conflict

The root cause of racial conflict is the perception of physiological differences between races. Conflicts arise when one race declares itself superior to another and starts oppressing it.

(iii) Class conflict

A fight between two classes is known as a class conflict. Karl Marx states that struggle between the exploiters and the exploited, the two economic strata that constitute society, has always existed.

(iv) Political conflict

Political parties that compete for political power are reported to be involved in political conflict.

(v) International conflict.

An international conflict is a conflict between two or more countries, or between several countries. It can be ideological, political, religious, economic, imperialistic, or for other reasons. For example, India and Pakistan are engaged in an international confrontation over Kashmir.

Conflict can also be of the following types:

(i) Latent and overt conflict: A latent conflict manifests itself as social tension and dissatisfaction, may remain latent for a long time without showing itself, and may eventually erupt into hostile actions. Once a problem or crisis is identified, the latent conflict becomes an overt conflict. Sometimes a latent conflict can persist for years before the problem or crisis becomes apparent.

(ii) Personal and corporate conflict: Personal and corporate conflicts can arise between two societies or between communal groups within a society. The language of corporate conflict

includes race wars, communal violence, religious oppression, labour-management conflict, international conflict, etc.

On the other hand, interpersonal conflicts often arise between members of a group. Interpersonal conflicts can be caused by many factors, but the most common causes are betrayal, hatred, and jealousy. Although interpersonal conflicts are less likely to lead to violence, they do not always do so. Even if they do not physically fight, a husband and wife will fight, a student will fight with a teacher, or a friend will fight with a friend.

The Function of Conflict

Conflict is an indispensable characteristic of society. The main theme of the development of society is constant war. According to Marx's explanation, it is the conflict of social classes. In Georg Simmel's view, it is impossible to find a social world without conflict, where only peace prevails; a society needs both unity and conflict in order to exist and mature. At this point, it will be helpful to briefly examine the good and bad aspects of conflict.

Positive Effects of Conflict

It is not wrong to accept that conflict has no negative aspects and is always harmful. Society solves its problems and grows through the never-ending conflicts and problems it experiences.

1. Sometimes a small amount of internal conflict indirectly supports the resolution of internal conflict. Occasional internal struggles within a group can lead to the preparation of leadership and the updating of policies. If there is no room for occasional conflict to erupt and it is actively suppressed, growing discontent will erupt and lead to permanent losses.

2. External conflict helps not only in internal consolidation but also in social cohesion and unity among the members of the society. During the Indo-Pak war, all political parties came together, forgetting their differences and supporting the Indian government in overcoming the challenge.

3. Personal conflicts also have some advantages. Only through permanent conflicts can people rise to the next level. The only way a person can become personally acceptable to another is through that person's hostility towards that other person.

Along with competition, conflict is an inevitable human and social characteristic. According to Simmel, a group cannot live completely united and without conflict.

Negative Effects of Conflict

On the other hand, conflict has its own disadvantages. Being the most intense social interaction, conflict evokes the strongest emotions and the strongest desires. The destruction of social solidarity is one of the consequences of conflict. It is a very expensive way to resolve disputes. Group cohesion is usually destroyed, and morale is reduced when there is conflict involving the group.

Conflicts cause social disintegration, confusion, and disorder. As one of the possible types of conflict, war can destroy the lives of many people and their property. In addition, people can suffer unimaginable suffering and sometimes permanent damage. Human history is one of the greatest proofs of this. The ability of modern warfare to wipe out millions of people and vast amounts of property in a matter of minutes has led people to develop new kinds of worries and fears.

In addition, conflict has caused a lot of moral and psychological injuries. Conflict destroys the mental peace of a person. Sometimes people become rude due to conflicts. Labour-management conflicts have caused material losses, while those who enjoy conflict do not pay much attention to moral and human values. Due to labour strikes that cause a decline in production, people and machines become idle.

Other than the above, Horton and Hunt have categorized the effects of conflict,

Integrative Effects

- Describe the issues.
- Lead to the concerns being addressed
- Increase unity in the group
- Lead to alliances with other organizations
- Remind groups of the interests of members.

Disintegrative Effects

- Make it more bitter
- Bring about devastation and violence
- Bring about conflict between groups
- Gets in the way of normal channels of cooperation
- Takes participants' attention away from group goals

Conflict performs the following useful functions, states H. T. Majumdar.

(i) Conflict increases solidarity within the group and strengthens morale.

(ii) If a conflict is resolved successfully, the winning group grows.

(iii) Value systems are redefined due to conflict.

(iv) Conflict may lead to the evolution of peaceful crisis resolution approaches.

(v) Conflict may change the relative positions of the conflicting parties.

(vi) Conflict may lead to a new consensus.

Differences between competition and conflict

Competition	Conflict
The attempt to monopolize a prize by outdoing all others is referred to as competition.	The act of attempting to get ahead by crushing or undermining all rivals is conflict.
Competition conscious or unconscious	All conflicts are a deliberate act.
There is eternal and universal competition.	Even though it is everywhere, conflict is not everywhere.
In this case, a person focuses his attention on an object or goal. Most of it is impersonal.	Here the focus is on the person, not the object, which happens occasionally. Therefore, it is mostly personal.
Conflict usually has negative impacts. It possesses more negative impacts than positive ones.	Competition can be good or bad. Healthy competition even helps things develop.
Too intense competition results in conflict.	Conflict comes about when competition becomes personal.

Relations between cooperation and conflict

Cooperation and conflict are elements of human society. Conflict and cooperation are not considered by C.H. Cooley as two opposites, but as different stages of a process that inherently includes both. Even in the closest relationships and relationships based on love, disagreements, differences of opinion or interests will always arise in the end. Since cooperation cannot go

beyond that, conflict is inevitable. For example, even the best cooperation in the family is not free from disputes.

Cooperation	Conflict
Cooperation is "joint activity in pursuit of common goals or shared rewards."	The habit of seeking to monopolize a reward by degrading or destroying competitors is called conflict.
There may be conscious or unconscious cooperation. It may not necessarily be an intentional act.	The nature of conflict is mostly conscious. It is mostly a deliberate act.
Empathy, identification, friendliness, and regard for others are prerequisites for cooperation.	But the most intense emotions and deepest feelings are always associated with conflict. There is no consideration for the other individuals involved.
Cooperation is a universal and ever-present phenomenon.	Of course, conflict is everywhere. But it happens occasionally, not constantly.
Cooperation generally produces beneficial results. It creates, maintains, and develops.	Conflicts can have negative consequences. They destroy, destroy, and hinder progress.
The basis of group life is cooperation. Without cooperation, there can be no society.	Human collective life is not defined by conflict. In the absence of conflict, society can exist.
Types: as direct and indirect cooperation, and primary, secondary, and tertiary cooperation.	Types: conflicts of impersonal ideas, class conflicts, individual conflicts, group conflicts, international conflicts, and religion, culture, race, and caste conflicts.

Conclusion

Conflict is the opposite process of cooperation. Any human action can become a way to destroy someone else's plan or shatter their hopes. However, it only becomes a conflict if there is a conscious resistance to it. In other words, conflict is competition in its most aggressive, disorderly, and closest to personal forms. Conflict is a method of obtaining rewards by discrediting or eliminating opponents. One party in a conflict seeks to eliminate the other, or at least to put it in a position of submission. Violence can occur without conflict, although it is mainly associated with it.

3.1-B- (iv) Accommodation

Accommodation is a form of communication in which the parties involved are at once antagonistic and cooperative. The truth is, much of human interaction is based on accommodation. Sometimes we agree to be different because we don't necessarily agree or disagree with the other person. Sometimes we keep a 'low profile' or refrain from making controversial statements. In most social interactions, we 'go with the flow', and even when we disagree with what is happening, we don't make strange comments. Accommodation enables opposing parties to maintain their different identities and perspectives while at the same time making some concessions in other areas, thus avoiding very destructive behaviour.

Accommodation may result from various adjustment processes including conciliation, compromise, arbitration, contracts, truces, and treaties.

Meaning of Accommodation

Accommodation is an important social process. The name comes from the term "Accommodation", which was introduced by the great psychologist I.M. Baldwin. As a result of this process, social order is established. Basically, according to Park and Burgess, the human social system is the result of reconciling opposing elements. Man has to deal with many contradictory situations during his life. Changes are always relevant because conflict cannot continue forever and man does not like the prospect of conflict.

Although conflict is the most common but still irregular social behaviour, groups cannot survive for long if they are in conflict. These problems must be overcome if social life is to be peaceful. Often, the process of adaptation in conflicts is one of adaptation to the new environment. The social environment or the physical may be the area that requires adjustment. The change to the latter occurs when an individual learns socially acquired behaviours and new behaviours, which is called accommodation, while the change to the former is achieved through inherited biological or structural change.

Like biological adaptation, social adaptation is also a social behaviour. According to J. M. Baldwin, accommodation is the changed behaviour of the individual that is learned and enables the individual to adapt to the environment. "Accommodation" is about the continuous adjustments that humans have to make to adapt to each other and to cope with situations.

This is done through accommodation, which is a process of establishing social patterns that tolerate individuals' cooperation, whether they like it or not. Thus, there will always be conflicts in life, but eventually the opposing parties will have to figure out how to cooperate.

Examples: A husband and wife may occasionally quarrel over trivial or important matters, but most of the time they live together with love and affection. Employees may go on strike today for whatever reason, but they will definitely report for duty tomorrow after reaching an agreement with the management. Students may sometimes skip class in the morning to protest against a particular college policy. But later, they are able to reconcile and continue their classes. Similarly, peace comes after war. The compromise or agreement reached by the parties and individuals involved in a dispute has been termed “accommodation” by sociologists.

Definition of Accommodation

(i) Reuter and Hart: “As a process, accommodation is the sequence of steps by which persons are reconciled to changed conditions of life through the formation of habits and attitudes made necessary by the changed conditions themselves”.

(ii) MacIver:- “The term accommodation refers particularly to the process in which man attains a sense of harmony with his environment”.

(iii) Ogburn and Nimkoff :- “Accommodation is the adjustment of hostile individuals or groups”.

(iv) Lundberg:- “The word accommodation has been used to designate the adjustments which people in groups make to relieve the fatigue and tensions of competition and conflict”.

(v) Gillin and Gillin:- “Accommodation is the process by which competing and conflicting individuals and groups adjust their relationship to each other in order to overcome the difficulties which arise in competition, contravention or conflict”.

(vi) Anderson and Parker:- “Accommodation is the achievement of adjustment between people that permits harmonious acting together in social situations”.

(vii) IM Baldwin: “Accommodation means acquired changes in the behaviour of individuals which help them to adjust to their environment”.

Characteristics of Accommodation

1. Conflict inevitably results in accommodation: Accommodations are always given a place in the system of conflicts because it is impossible to go on with conflicts. The parties or

individuals involved in a dispute, when they do not like the situation, sit down and resolve it. These temporary or final solutions can be called accommodations. When there is no conflict, the issue of seeking accommodation does not arise.

2. The changes that people make to their social environment can be conscious or unconscious: Much of human social adaptation is unconscious. Man has to behave according to a normative order from birth to death. The infant learns to adapt to the social order, which is governed by a series of rules such as conventions, morals, and traditions. If he fails to adapt to the social environment, he will never be accepted as a full member of the group. Thus, the new-born automatically makes accommodations for his family. In fact, the entire context refers to caste or ethnicity, neighbourhood, playgroup, school, church, and workplace. Unintentional types of adaptive behaviour are found everywhere in the normal course of life.

3. Accommodation is present everywhere: Since human society is made up of groups that are hostile to each other, there will always be disagreements. Since no group can survive in a state of constant disagreement, accommodation is necessary. Therefore, accommodation exists in all societies and in all areas of social life.

4. Accommodation is a lifelong practice: The process of accommodation does not end at any particular stage in a person's life. Moreover, it is not limited to any particular social environment. In fact, one has to adapt to many situations throughout life. Furthermore, accommodations are eventually made when the situation demands it. People and groups in society have to make accommodations with each other.

5. The consequences of accommodations may vary depending on the circumstances: Accommodation may be the first step in a process of assimilation with the goal of reducing conflict between people or groups. It may be used to avoid direct conflict, as in a labour-management agreement or a treaty between countries. It may allow groups with very different socio-psychological characteristics to coexist. This may be beneficial to all. Sometimes, it is used by the more powerful or superior side to dominate the weaker side.

Forms or Methods of Accommodation

Settlement is the process by which a group of people develops economic and other life patterns through the acquisition or creation of tools. They are integrated or complemented with the life patterns of others. Park and Burgess define this process as a change that is directly influenced by war among people and groups. Ultimately, humans must resolve all conflicts in their society.

This consensus reached by the parties to a dispute is what sociologists have called "Accomodation".

The ways in which dispute resolution or settlement can be achieved are limitless. They can be achieved in many different forms and ways, most of which are listed below:

1. Submission under duress or admitting defeat: The use of force or threat of force to put an end to conflict is called coercion. Typically, direct participants are two combatants of unequal strength; the weaker one surrenders either because of defeat or because of fear of defeat. An example of such a compromise is a peace treaty or armistice signed after a war.

2. Compromise: If the two opponents are on equal footing and neither can defeat the other, they will reach a compromise and reach a decision. In a compromise, both parties to the dispute acknowledge that the other has some valid demands and agree to give up a certain amount of themselves. Such agreements are necessary for resolving parliamentary disputes.

3. Arbitration and Conciliation: These are processes in which a third party attempts to resolve a disagreement between conflicting parties and leads to a settlement. Labour-management conflicts and sometimes even political conflicts are resolved through the intervention of an arbitrator or mediator who is fully trusted by both parties.

The process of bringing people who are separated together and convincing them to consider a possible solution to their problem is called mediation. If the parties involved feel that they are unable to reach an agreement on their own, the mediator can even offer a basis for a solution. However, the mediator's instructions are not legally binding. Unlike arbitration, in mediation the parties acting as mediators make a decision on the issue at hand, and their decision is legally binding.

4- Tolerance: This only involves evasive tactics to avoid direct confrontation without attempting to resolve differences. Since such cases refer to situations of incompatible philosophies, conflicts cannot be resolved. When it comes to religion, tolerance is best illustrated when several religious groups coexist.

5. Conversion: Conversion occurs when one side of a conflict comes to the conclusion that one side is wrong and the other side is right. This occurs by rejecting the beliefs or allegiances of one party and adopting the beliefs of the other. Conversion is generally associated only with religion, however, it can also occur in politics, economics, and other media.

6. Rationalization: Individuals who adapt through rationalization find plausible excuses or reasons for their behaviour, rather than admitting their true fault. Individuals and groups engage in giving completely fabricated reasons for their behaviour.

7. Superordination and Subordination: The most common form of accommodation is the creation and acceptance of a hierarchy of superodination and subordination. The structure of any society is essentially the result of this type of accommodation. The basis of the relationship between children and parents in a family is superodination and subordination. Relationships in larger social or economic groups are also based on the same basis.

Need for Accommodation

Social life can barely exist without accommodation. Therefore, any society, since it is the main enemy of social cohesion, social order and social stability, tries to resolve conflicts as soon as possible. Accommodation reduces conflict and facilitates communication between individuals and societies. It also allows individuals and organizations to adapt to new roles and restrictions resulting from changes in circumstances. It makes it possible for them to live together, even though they have different interests.

It is a method of solving problems that leaves the other side intact to some extent. Thus, hostile or conflicting parties or elements can work together. For this reason, it is often called "antagonistic cooperation". Different political parties that are opposed to each other may agree to unite in order to protect a third party. Accommodation can also exist at the social or personal level.

3.1-B- (v) Assimilation

Introduction

Assimilation is a form of interrelationship. Like settlement, it is also a type of social arrangement. However, compared to settlement, it is of a more permanent nature. If the relationship between individuals, groups or groupings existed only at the level of settlement, the merging of tribes and their cultures would not have occurred. The process by which one culture is absorbed and integrated into another is called assimilation.

Meaning of Assimilation

Assimilation is the process by which individuals and groups absorb the culture of another group in which they live, adopting its values, attitudes, thoughts, and ways of behaving. Assimilation, therefore, means making more significant changes than simply adapting. As integration

progresses, members of two different groups not only make concessions to each other, but also become indistinguishable. The best-known example of assimilation is, assimilation of foreigners into the host culture, that is, the abandonment of their own culture and the adoption of the culture of the host country.

However, it would be wrong to limit the process of assimilation to this one area. Assimilation also occurs in other situations. For example, as children grow up and learn proper behaviour, they gradually integrate into adult society. Sometimes adopted children completely adopt new behaviours from their adoptive parents, so that they erase all traces of the influence of their former home. When two people from different backgrounds marry for the first time, they often unexpectedly find themselves sharing common interests and goals. In the religious sphere, people can change from one religion to another.

Definition of Assimilation

The following are a few definitions of assimilation:

(i) Park and Burgess:- "Assimilation is a process of interpenetration and fusion in which persons and groups acquire the memories, sentiments, attitudes of other persons or groups and by sharing their experiences and history are incorporated with them in a cultural life".

(ii) Biesanz :- "Assimilation is the social process whereby individuals or groups come to share the same sentiments and goals".

(iii) Nimkoff:- "Assimilation is the process whereby individuals or groups once dissimilar become similar, and identified in their interest and outlook".

(iv) Lundberg:- "Assimilation is a word used to designate a process of mutual adjustment through which culturally different groups gradually obliterate their differences to the point where they are no longer regarded as socially significant or observable".

(v) Horton and Hunt:- "The process of mutual cultural diffusion through which persons and groups come to share a common culture is called assimilation".

(vi) Young and Mack:- "Assimilation is the fusion or blending of two previously distinct groups into one".

(vii) Bogardus:- "Assimilation is the social process whereby attitudes of many persons are united, and thus develop into a united group".

(viii) Samuel Koenig :- “Assimilation is the process whereby persons and groups acquire the culture of another group”.

Characteristics of Assimilation

1. Assimilation is not restricted to one area: The merging of two different cultural groups is commonly called assimilation. However, this process is not limited to any one area. For example, children become more and more familiar with the adult world. Usually, when a husband and wife come from different backgrounds, they surprisingly discover that they share common interests and goals. In religion, assimilation may occur when an individual or group of individuals from a particular religious background decide to join a different religious group or organization. As a group process, assimilation does not stop at one aspect of life, but takes into account everything.

2. The process of assimilation is slow and gradual; It cannot happen suddenly. Of course, it takes time, so it usually takes time for two groups and characters to become one. This can only happen when there is relatively continuous and direct communication. The type of relationships that exist determines how quickly the assimilation process occurs. If the relationships are close, assimilation can occur very quickly and naturally. On the other hand, if the relationships are superficial and indirect, assimilation will be much slower.

3. The process of assimilation is unconscious: When people undergo the process of assimilation, they do not realize that this is happening to them personally or to their group: often, people and groups replace their old cultural heritage with a new one without even realizing it.

4. The process of assimilation is mutual: The concept of give and take is part of assimilation. In general, it is usually preceded by a process called "acculturation." In this case, two cultural groups come together, one removing elements of the other's culture and then mixing them with its own. Basically, both groups are affected when they come into contact. The culturally "weaker" group often takes on most of the characteristics of the culturally "stronger" group.

Factors Favouring Assimilation

1. Toleration: Assimilation is only possible when individuals and societies are tolerant of the cultural diversity of others. Tolerant people are more willing to make contact, establish relationships, and share social and cultural activities. If the majority or dominant group is

friendly, helpful, and tolerant of differences, immigrant groups in minorities will have more opportunities to join and participate in integrated community life.

2. Close social ties: Social interactions lead to assimilation. The nature of the contacts significantly affects the speed at which this process occurs. Assimilation occurs almost immediately and is very noticeable in primary groups such as families and friendship circles. On the other hand, in places where interactions are secondary in nature, people are indirect, impersonal, and superficial, so assimilation is slow.

3. Amalgamation or intermarriage: As this term describes, the union of different communities is a factor that helps in complete assimilation. Without integration, one cannot achieve complete integration biologically. A limited amount of group mixing does not necessarily lead to assimilation. Before assimilation can take place, interfaith belief or integration must first be accepted at the level of norms and incorporated into an institutional framework, although that is a prerequisite.

4. Cultural similarity: The process of assimilation is much faster if the main aspects of the cultures of the two groups are very similar. For example, English-speaking Protestants assimilate into the United States more quickly than non-Christians who do not speak that language.

5. Education: Education is another factor that leads to the integration process. Immigrant cultural exposure through general education has been very helpful.

6. Equitable access to social and economic opportunities: Public education alone is not enough. All members of different groups must have equal access to socio-economic opportunities. Only in this way can they come closer to each other and build trusting relationships. the full integration is possible only when they have full access to social, cultural and economic life.

Hindrances and Aids to Assimilation

Assimilation is not a simple process, but a process involving many levels and complexities. While some conditions support assimilation, there are others that hinder or delay it. The speed at which a cultural minority assimilates depends on whether the facilitating or hindering factors are more dominant.

Factors that favour assimilation include tolerance, equal economic opportunity, a sympathetic attitude of the majority towards the minority, contact with the majority culture, cultural

similarities between the two groups, and intermarriage. On the other hand, factors that hinder or delay assimilation include a superiority complex of the dominant group, extreme physical, cultural, and social differences between the groups, oppression of minority groups by the majority group, and isolation of living conditions.

MacIver lists the aspects that serve as justifications for some groups being easily accepted and others being subjected to intense opposition:

1. Entered the current level of development of the society: The conditions that existed at the time of the immigrant's arrival determine to some extent the reception that the immigrant receives in his new country.

2. Prior occupational skills: An immigrant who has already acquired the training and skills needed for a job in demand in the new country is more likely to succeed. For example, immigrants with industrial skills can find acceptance more easily in countries with less developed industrial sectors, while the same is true for those from rural areas in countries with agricultural economies.

3. The numbers involved: It has been observed that the attitude of a group is mostly positive until the number of outsiders reaches a significant proportion. The resistance of the established group to the integration of newcomers becomes stronger with the percentage of the latter.

4. Physical differences: Differences in skin colour, features, or some other physical characteristic may facilitate or hinder assimilation. Racial barriers delay assimilation, because while one can put aside one's own culture, one cannot put aside one's own race. Discrimination between the Negro and white races is found in almost every corner of the world. In general, immigrants who resemble the native population of the country will have the least difficulty in making adjustments.

5. Cultural differences: Usually, the elements of culture that are most dependent on are religion and language. Immigrants can adapt to their new country more quickly if they share the same language and religion as the natives.

6. The role of the semi-community: Sometimes large-scale immigrants settle in small communities, where they follow their traditional customs rather than blending in with the local culture. These quasi-communities play a crucial role in the integration process in two ways. On the one hand, a community that largely retains old ways of life allows newcomers to adapt

quickly to the new situation and identify with their fellow citizens. On the other hand, most people find the existence of such groups strange and repulsive.

DIFFERENCE BETWEEN ACCOMMODATION AND ASSIMILATION

Accommodation	Assimilation
Accommodation can happen abruptly and drastically.	The process of assimilation is gradual and slow. It requires time
It might or might not offer a long-term resolution to conflicts and disagreements inside the organization. It might only offer a short-term fix.	Assimilation typically offers a long-term resolution to conflicts and disagreements between groups.
This process can be conscious or unconscious. Most often, it happens consciously.	This process is largely unconscious. Often, those involved are unaware of what is actually happening within themselves or their group.

Conclusion

Society encompasses an extensive range of socially constructed relationships. Given their complexity and immeasurable nature, it is practically impossible to undertake a comprehensive study of every individual relationship. Consequently, these relationships must be organized into broader categories that reflect general patterns of interaction. Such patterns, commonly referred to as social processes, it provide a framework for analysing the dynamics of social life. Key forms of these interaction processes include cooperation, competition, conflict, accommodation and assimilation.

Questions

MCQ

1. Who defined ‘Social interaction is the reciprocal influence human beings exert on each other through inter stimulation and response’

A) Gist, NP B) Green

C) Robert Park C) Fairchild

2. Find put odd one

A) Cooperation B) Competition

C) Conflict D) **Isolation**

3. Which type of social interaction involves two or more groups or individuals work together to accomplish shared objectives or interests, it is called?

A) Conflict B) Accommodation .

C) **Cooperation** D) Assimilation

4. According to Park and Burgess, the two essential elements for social interaction are ...…..?

A) Cooperation and Conflict B) Status and role

C) Accommodation and Assimilation D) **Contact and communication**

5. Two main components of cooperation are ……..?

A) Common end and Organized effort B) Aim and Purpose

C) Rewards and Common goal D) Mutual knowledge and Understanding

6. Cooperation refers to:

A) Working for individual benefit only

B) **Working together to achieve common goals**

C) Competing for limited resources

D) Avoiding social interaction

7. The term "co-operation" is derived from the Latin words, its meaning is ……

A) Together and to work B) Understanding and relationship

C) Achieve shared goals D) Protect interest and help others

8. The type of cooperation occurs when people does the same work, it is known as

A) Direct cooperation B) Primary cooperation

C) Tertiary cooperation D) Secondary cooperation

9. The type of cooperation occurs when people perform different task to achieve a common goal, it is termed as …….?

A) Indirect cooperation B) Primary cooperation

C) Direct cooperation D) Tertiary cooperation

10 .Which type of cooperative behaviour exist in business organization, churches and government agencies?

A) Secondary cooperation B) Tertiary cooperation

C) Direct cooperation D) Primary cooperation

11. The division of labour and specialization serves as the foundation for ……. cooperation.

A) Indirect cooperation B) Tertiary cooperation

C) Direct cooperation D) Primary cooperation

12. Which type of cooperation is seen in groups like family or friendship groups?

A) Primary cooperation B) Indirect cooperation

C) Secondary cooperation D) Direct cooperation

13. Opportunistic attitudes is one of the characteristics of ……. Cooperation

A) Tertiary co-operation B) Indirect cooperation

C) Secondary cooperation D) All of the above

14. Who defined "Competition is an interaction without social contact"?

A) Park and Burgess B) Bogardus

C) Green D) Horton and Hunt

15. Which of the following is not a characteristics of competition?

A) Competition is endless **B) Competition is static**

C) Competition causes social change D) competition is sub/conscious process

16. Which of the following is an example of economic competition?

A) Individual fight for jobs B) people struggle for political power

C) Cultural groups preserving traditions D) Political parties competing for votes

17. Which of the following is not a positive function of competition?

A) Proper positioning of people B) Sources of motivation

C) Fostering progress **D) It leads to monopoly**

18. Who defined “Conflict as ‘the deliberate attempt to oppose, resist or coerce the will of another or others”?

A) W. Green B) Bogardus

C) Anderson and Parker D) Gist NP

19. Which of the following sociologists considered human history as the history of class struggle?

A) Karl Marx B) W Green

C) CH Cooley D) Gillin and Gillin

20. Which of the following is not a type of conflict mentioned by George Simmel?

A) War B) Feud conflict

C) Litigation D) **Personal Conflict**

21. which of the following is a type of conflict mentioned by Gillin and Gillin?

A) Litigation **B) Class conflict**

C) War D) Factional conflict

22. The term accommodation coined by …….?

A) IM Baldwin B) Mac Iver

C) Lundberg D) CH Cooley

23. ……. continuous adjustments that humans have to make to adapt to each other and to cope with situations

A) Accommodation B) Assimilation

C) Competition D) Conflict

24. "Accommodation is the adjustment of hostile individuals or groups", defined by?

A) Ogburn and Nimkoff B) Anderson and Parker

C) Lundberg D) MacIver

25. Which of the following is not a method of accommodation?

A) Tolerance B) Compromise

C) Conflict D) Conversion

26. The process of adjusting or compromising after a conflict is known as:

A) Competition **B) Accommodation**

C) Cooperation D) Opposition

27. Which type of social interaction involves rivalry for scarce resources?

A) Cooperation **B) Competition**

C) Accommodation D) Assimilation

28. When a minority group gradually adopts the culture of the dominant group, it is termed as

A) Assimilation B) Cooperation

C) Conflict D) Accommodation

29. Which type of interaction refers to the deliberate attempt to oppose, resist, or coerce the will of another or others, often involving violence or threats?

A) Competition B) Accommodation

C) Conflict D) Exchange

30. The process by which one culture is absorbed and integrated into another is called

A) Assimilation B) Cooperation

C) Accommodation D) All of the above

31. Which of the following is not a characteristics of accommodation?

A) Assimilation is not restricted to one area

B) **Assimilation is very fast process**

C) Assimilation is unconscious

D) Assimilation is mutual

Short note

1. What do you mean by social interaction?

2. What are the two essential elements of social interaction?

3. Define cooperation

4. Explain conflict as a social process

5. Define assimilation and give one example

6. Define accommodation

7. Differentiate between direct and indirect cooperation.

8. Point out any two positive effects of conflict

9. List out any two characteristics of assimilation

10. Mention any two types of competition with example

Short essay

1. Discuss the major forms of cooperation

2. Discuss nature and characteristics of competition
3. Competition have any role in social life? Substantiate your answer
4. Differentiate between cooperation and competition as social processes
5. What do you mean by conflict? Discuss the major characteristics of conflict.
6. Explain the meaning and importance of accommodation in maintaining social order.
7. Describe the various forms or methods of accommodation and illustrate them with suitable examples.
8. Explain the meaning and essential features of assimilation
9. Describe the social functions of competition.
10. Compare and contrast between accommodation and assimilation
11. Discuss the major factors that encourage assimilation in society.

Essay

1. Define social interaction and Explain the different types of social interaction with suitable example
2. Analyze both positive and negative consequences of competition in society.